Meaning from Craft

OUR TEAM



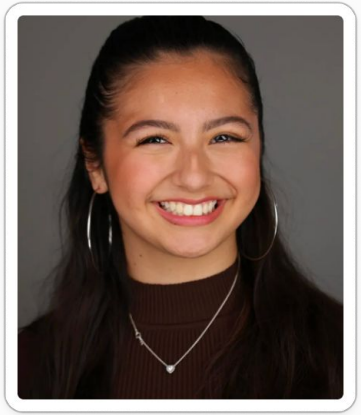
Ahyan
BS CS



Elsa
BS Design
MS HCI

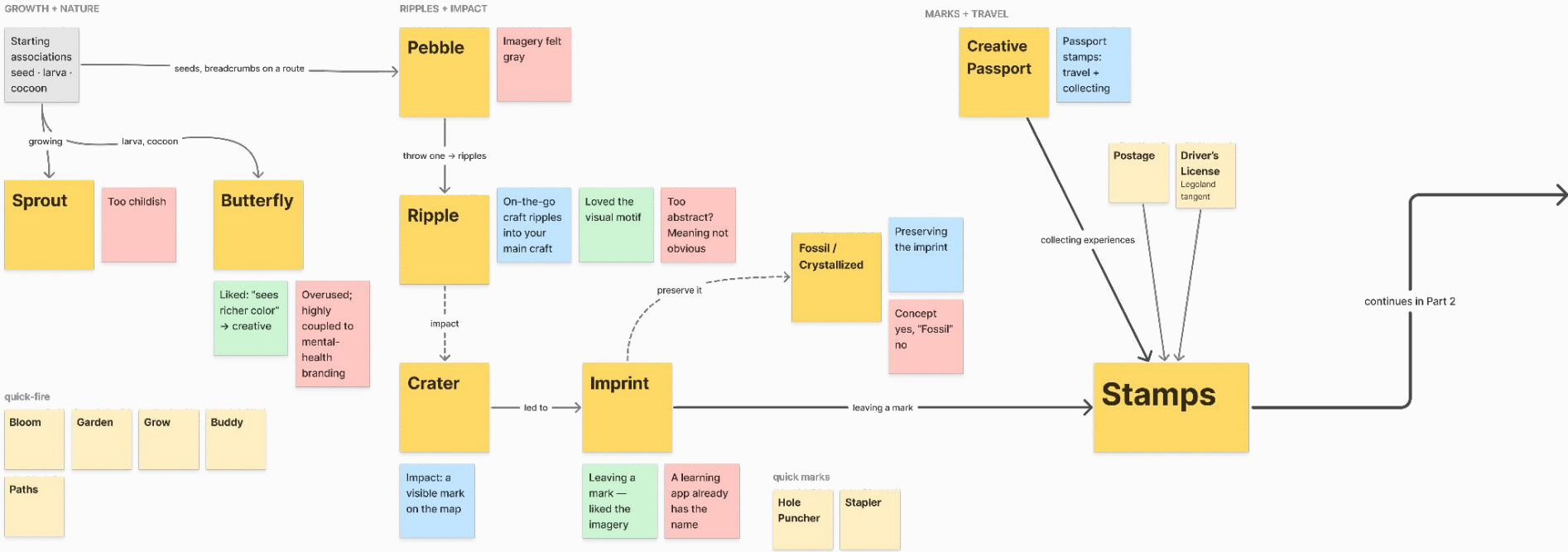


Jia
BS Design
MS HCI

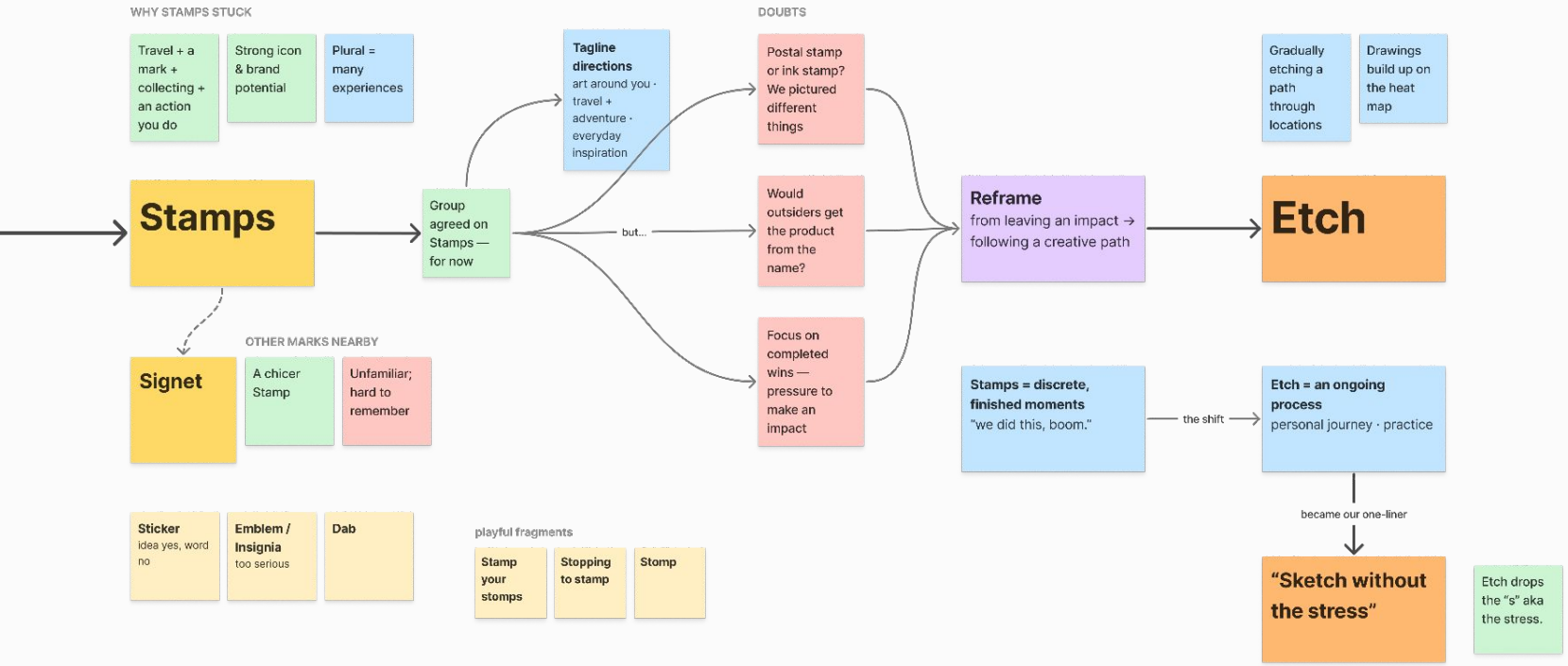


Kelly
BS HCI
MS AI

Name Brainstorm



Name Brainstorm



etch

Sketch Without The Stress

We chose our project name to showcase intentionality in the process of creating

VALUE PROPOSITION

Make creativity an adventure again with a low-pressure way to experiment and play, without expectations of polished work or a finished result

The Problem & Our Solution

Problem/Solution/Primary User

Creative people whose craft has become tied to work or expectations often struggle to make room for experimentation and play. Our phone case with built-in sketch tools and a companion app makes outdoor creative breaks easy: seeing others' art nearby encourages users to pause, create without pressure, and revisit their discoveries for inspiration in their main craft

Problem /Solution /Primary User

Creative people whose craft has become tied to work or expectations often struggle to make room for experimentation and play. Our phone case with built-in sketch tools and a companion app makes outdoor creative breaks easy: seeing others' art nearby encourages users to pause, create without pressure, and revisit their discoveries for inspiration in their main craft

Problem

Creative people can struggle to make time for creating just for themselves. When making becomes tied to work, expectations, or proving their ability, even a creative break can feel like another task. They need an easy starting point and room to experiment, enjoy the process, and remember what they love about making

Solution

A phone case with built-in paints and a brush, paired with a companion app make it easy to take creative breaks outdoors. Discover places where others have made art, follow a prompt or create freely, and share anonymously.

Create ephemeral art on seed paper, plant your work, and build a personal map of the places that inspire you, reconnecting with the joy of making for yourself without the pressure of a “good” artistic outcome

Solution User Journey

You're out for a walk and get notified when you pass a place where others have created a lot of art in this area.

Creating while outdoors can ease the pressure to make something perfect and seeing others create art can give permission to take a break

You pull paints and a brush from your phone case and take out a piece of paper that has flower seeds embedded into it.

Having supplies close at hand lowers the effort of starting especially in moments of spontaneity and exploration

Ask for a prompt if you need a starting point, or paint whatever catches your attention.

Artists benefit from both prompts that help them start and freedom to draw on personal experiences

When you're done, you can add a photo of your artwork anonymously to the map. Then plant the paper and let what you made grow so you don't overly focus on the end result .

Crafters need opportunities to reconnect with the joy of making for themselves, without seeking external validation

Market research

Sketch a Day

Daily drawing prompts and a community for sharing art

What works →

Daily prompts help with “What should I draw?”

Different takes on a prompt spark ideas

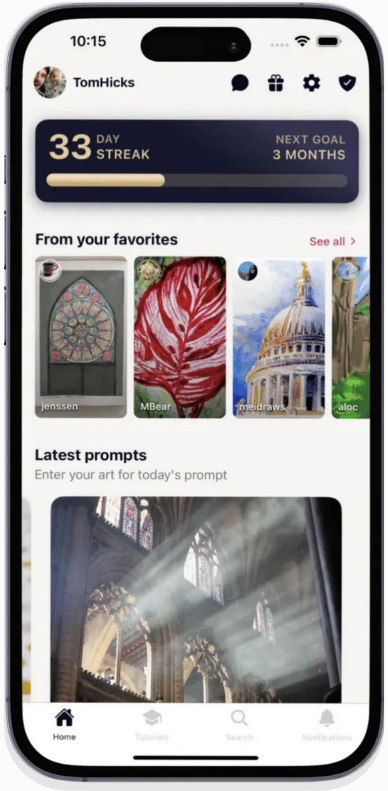
A welcoming community makes starting easier

What falls short →

Likes and comparisons may bring back pressure

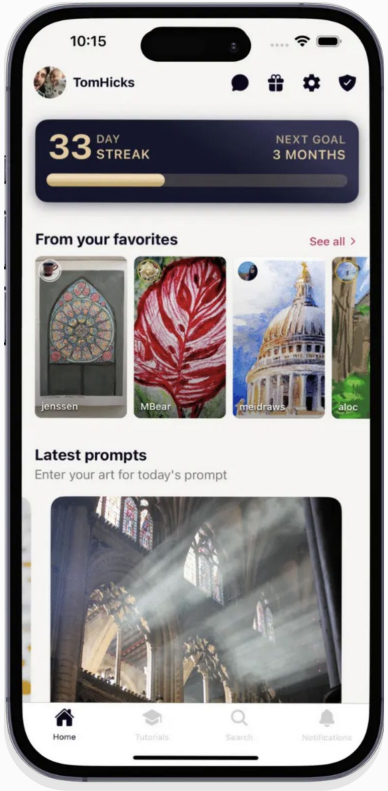
Streaks may turn a break into another obligation

The core experience isn’t tied to outdoor places



Sketch a Day

Daily drawing prompts and a community for sharing art



What we can take away →

- Offer optional prompts when people need a starting point
- Let people create freely and share anonymously, without likes or streaks
- Help people discover art spots, add their own, and return over time
- Build a personal record of moments that can inspire fashion, crafts, and other creative work

Pokémon Go

Location-based exploration through gamification

What works →

Turns ordinary locations into destinations

Rewards and collectibles motivate exploration

Community-created Routes encourage discovery

What falls short →

Rewards may shift focus toward achievement over experience

Engagement can fade as novelty wears off

Location tracking raises privacy and safety concerns



Pokémon Go

Location-based exploration through gamification

What we can take away →

- Turn everyday locations into opportunities for creative discovery
- Borrow playful exploration without competitive rewards or rankings
- Let users unlock anonymous artwork by creating their own
- Prioritize personal meaning, privacy, and different location vibes



Sktchr

A field companion app for urban sketchers

What works →

Community map shows how others drew at the same spot

Planning tools for lighting, crowds, weather, & accessibility help artists pick when/where to go

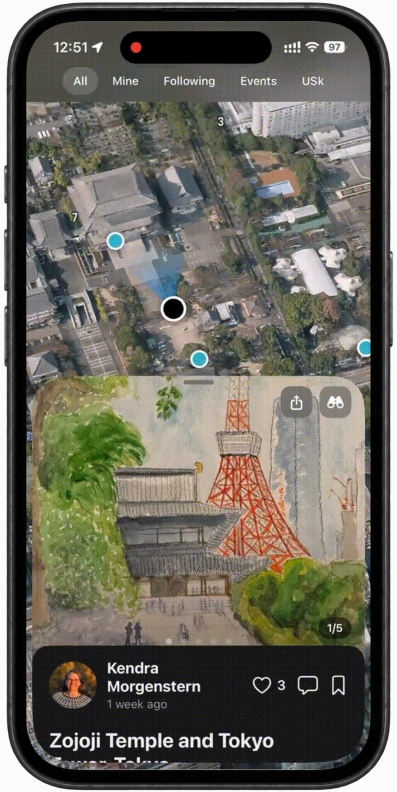
Personal archive keeps sketches by place and time

What falls short →

Cold start: map feels empty wherever few sketchers are active

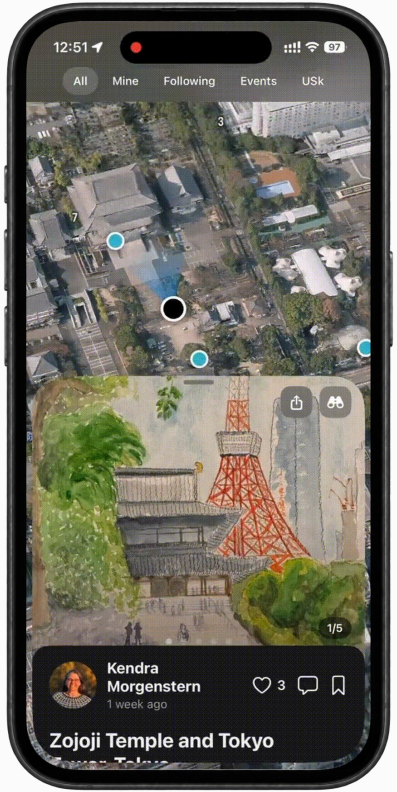
Built for planned outings, not a spontaneous few minutes

Centered on finished, polished sketches more than low-stakes play



Sktchr

A field companion app for urban sketchers



What we can take away →

- Keep a personal record of art and the places it was made
- Seed the map with local art community so it isn't empty on day one
- Show nearby art as an invitation to pause, not a gallery to measure up to

iNaturalist

Record wildlife you find and identify it with a community

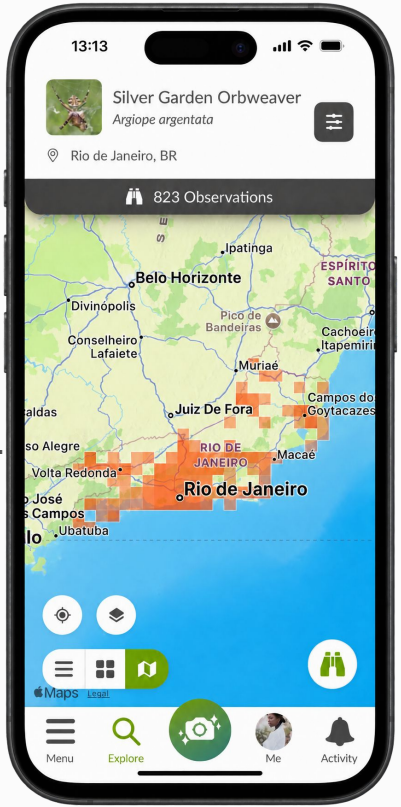
What works →

Gives people a reason to stop and notice the ordinary

You can post without knowing what you found → super low barrier to participate and enjoy

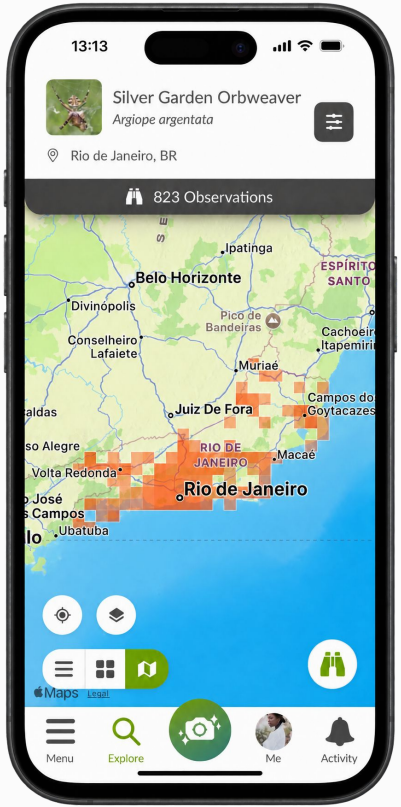
What falls short →

Tension in values: one of nature's meanings is to be basked in (without screens), but this app implicitly asks users to insert their devices into that process



iNaturalist

Record wildlife you find and identify it with a community



What we can take away →

- Let people create and share without needing to get anything “right”
- Incentivize users to get off the app and into their craft as soon as they’ve received what they need from the experience we are building for them (inspiration)
- Design so that users don’t get stuck on their phones by scrolling through all the other art (i.e. rigorously consider how to not fall into addictive design)

Feature Comparison

	Easy starting point	Room to play	New places	Others' art nearby	Supplies at hand	Made for yourself	Remember what you made
Sketch a Day direct	Daily prompt	One set prompt a day	No	Global feed, not nearby	Bring your own	Posted to a feed	Gallery
Pokémon GO indirect	Game tells you where to go	Fixed game goals	Core to the game	No art	Not needed	Game progress	Collection
sktchr direct	Spot map + light forecast	Open, but skill-focused tools	Planned trips	On the map	Bring your own	Shared to the map	Archive by place
iNaturalist indirect	Snap whatever you find	Open-ended exploring at your own pace	Anywhere outside	Others' finds, not art	Not needed	Shared with a community	Observation history
Sketchbook + paints status quo	Up to you	Totally open	If you choose	No	A kit you carry	Private	The sketchbook
etch our proposal	Optional prompt from nearby art	Prompt or freeform + plantable paper	Wherever you are	On the map	Built into the phone case	Private, or share anonymously	Personal map

easy, but it's for the game, not for making

lots of room to play, just not for art

closest competitor

free, but you bring everything

What jumped out

Nobody else puts supplies in your hand

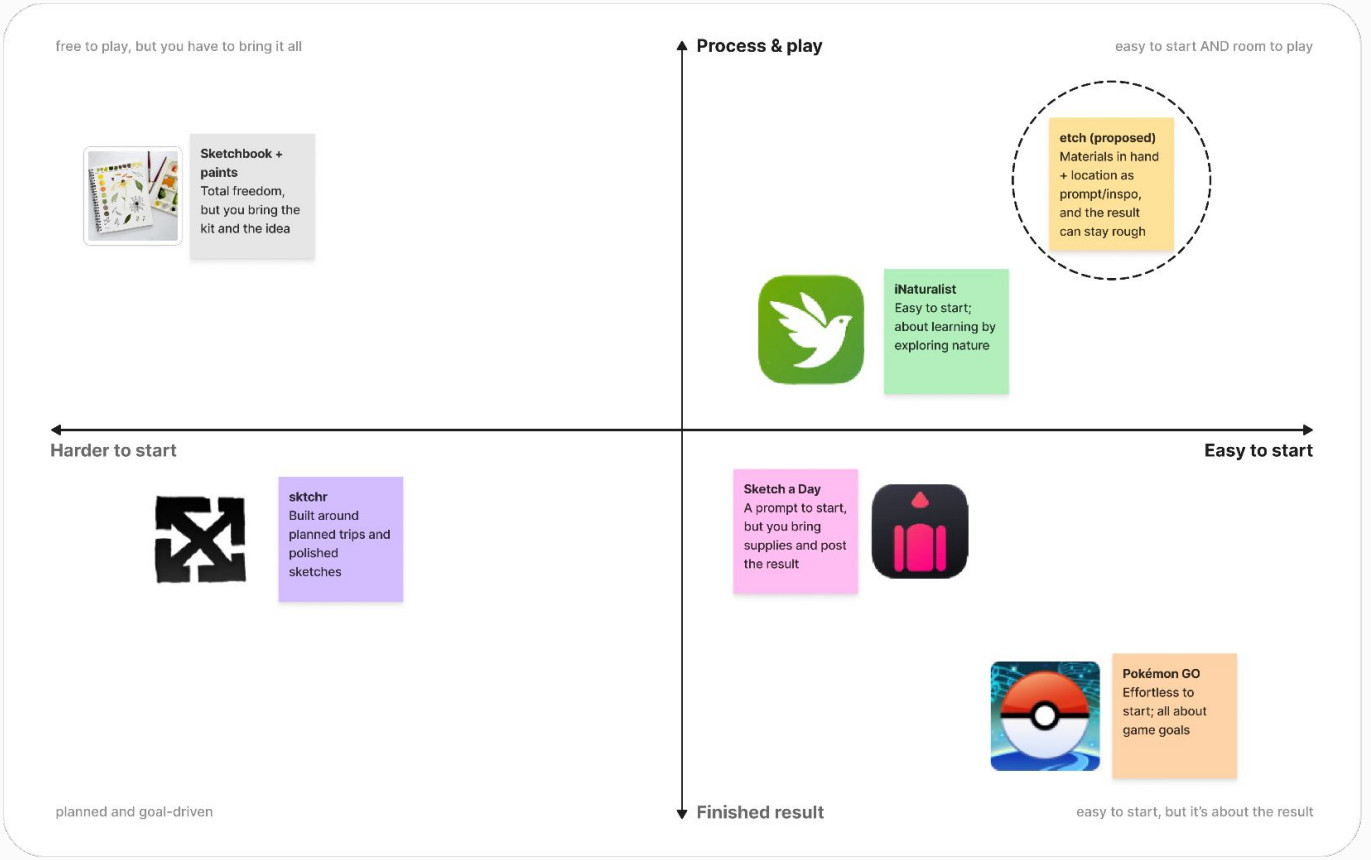
An easy start usually comes with a fixed goal (Pokémon GO)

iNaturalist nails an easy start and room to play, it's just about nature, not making art

Total freedom usually means bringing everything yourself (sketchbook)

sktchr is the only other one with art on a map, but it's built for planned trips

Where etch fits



Axes we tried

~~**Place-based vs. not**~~
→ almost everything is place-based, so it doesn't separate anyone

~~**Social vs. solo**~~
→ not what our problem is about

~~**Public feedback vs. none**~~
→ a side effect, not the core need

Easy to start × process vs. result
→ straight from our problem statement ✓

Design Values

DIRECT STAKEHOLDERS

Beginners: Exploring art without pressure

Casual crafters: Seeking inspiration and creative breaks

Experienced artists: Finding new creative perspectives

Returning crafters: Reconnecting with abandoned hobbies

Art contributors: Sharing their creations to inspire other users

INDIRECT STAKEHOLDERS

Businesses: May gain foot traffic

Bystanders: May appear in shared artwork

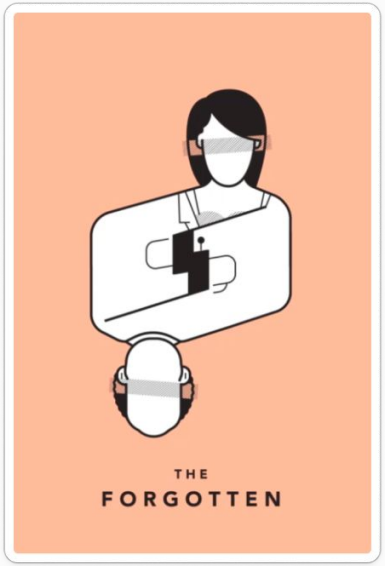
Local residents: Affected by increased visitors

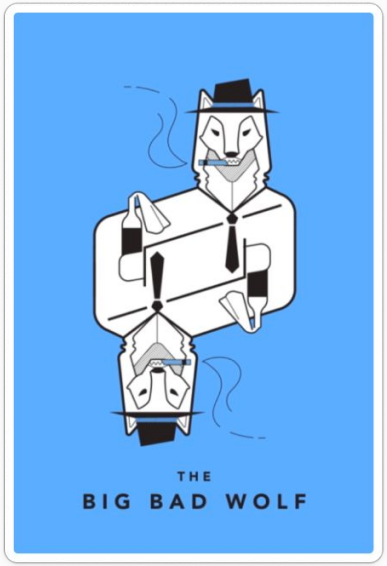
Environment: Affected by foot traffic or art waste

Property owners: Affected by activity at featured locations

TAROT CARD ANALYSIS



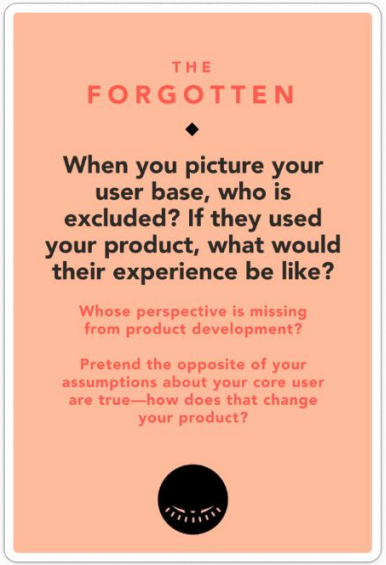


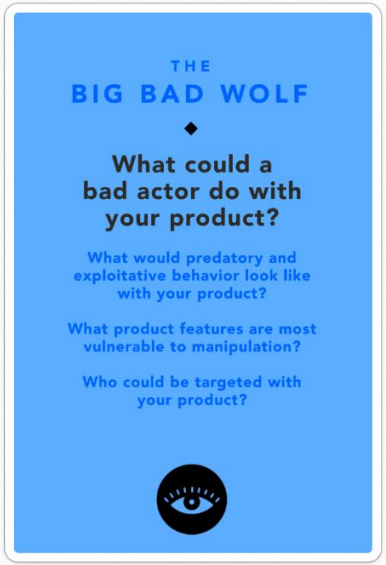




TAROT CARD ANALYSIS









How does our app affect friendships?

Ethical Implications

Friends' artwork may create comparison pressure.

Anonymity limits connections between artists.



Design Responses

No likes, comments, or rankings.

Optional anonymous collaboration.

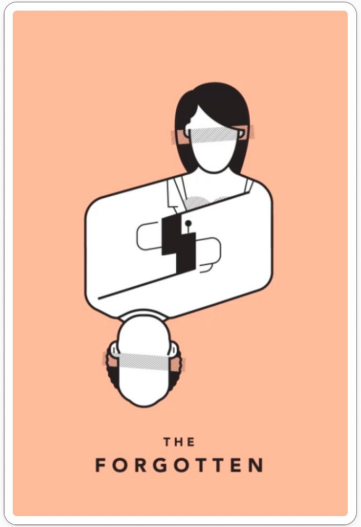
Value Tension: Community vs. freedom

Who might our app exclude?

Ethical Implications

Users with mobility limitations may struggle to reach locations.

Beginners may feel uncomfortable creating art in public.



Design Responses

Recommend accessible, nearby locations.

Allow users to create privately after visiting.

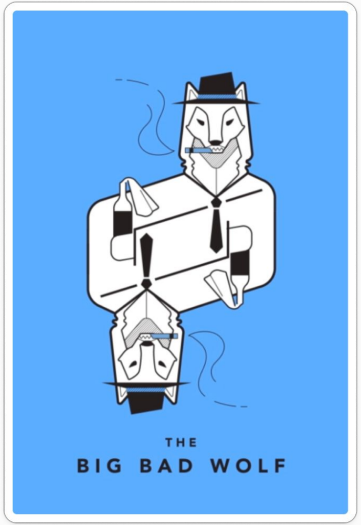
Value Tension: Adventure vs. accessibility

How could our app be misused?

Ethical Implications

Artwork posts could reveal users' locations, enabling stalking.

Anonymous uploads may contain harmful or inappropriate content.



Design Responses

Hide artist identities and posting times to prevent tracking.

Moderate uploads and allow users to report harmful content.

Value Tension: Discovery vs. privacy

When does our app become distracting?

Ethical Implications

Frequent notifications may turn creativity into an obligation.

Users may feel pressured to visit locations or create constantly.



Design Responses

Allow users to customize or disable notifications.

Avoid streaks and time-sensitive rewards that create pressure.

Value Tension: Engagement vs. well-being

Tasks

Brain storm

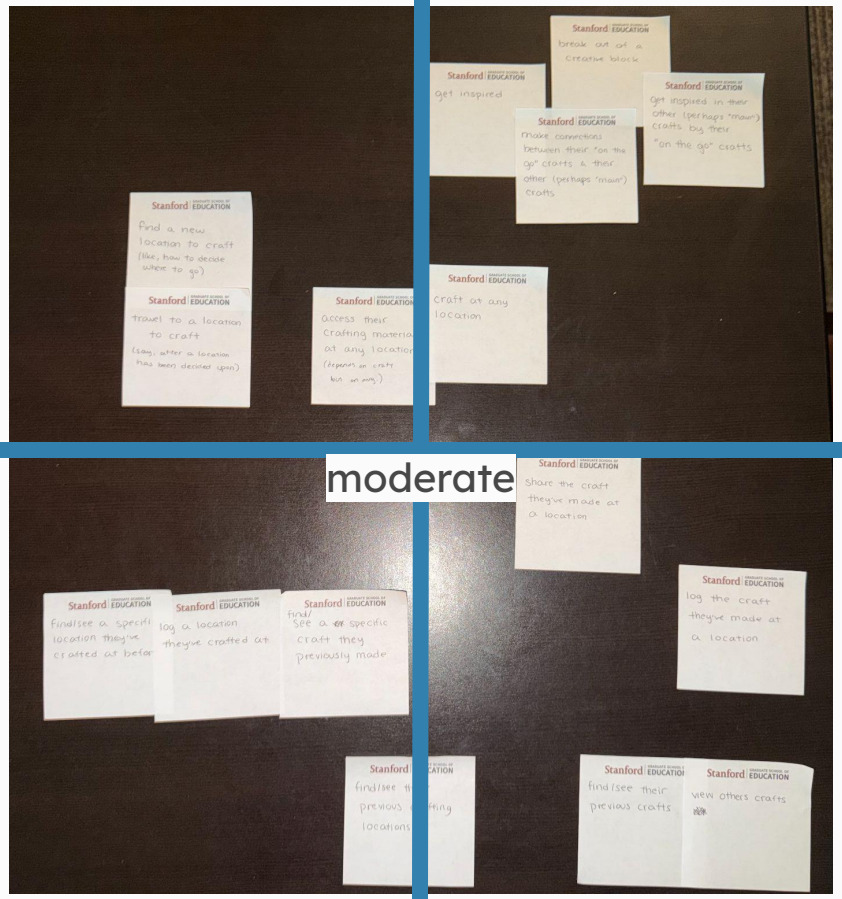
complex

low priority for user

high priority for user

moderate

simple



Brain storm

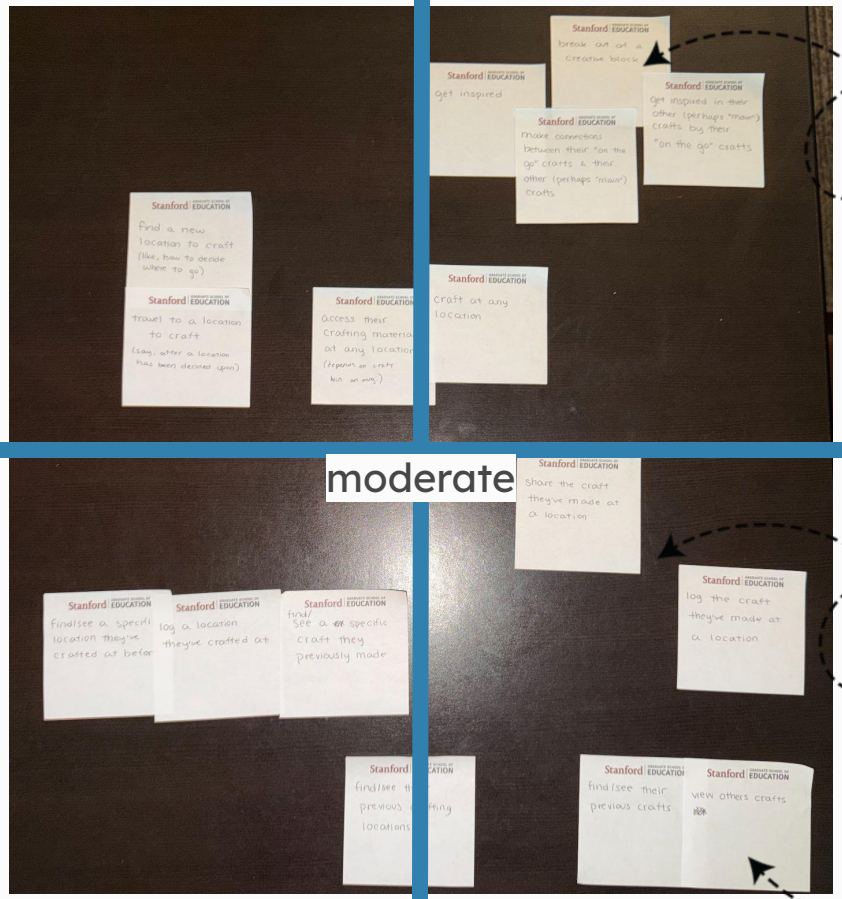
complex

low priority for user

high priority for user

moderate

simple



Task 3: Find connections to main craft

Task 2: Create and share crafts

Task 1: Discover inspiration

SIMPLE

Discover inspiration

Find nearby outdoor spots where others have made art

MODERATE

Create and share

Follow a prompt or paint freely, then share what you made

COMPLEX

Find connections to main craft

Find connections across your past “low stress” inspiration to shape a new project in your main craft

SIMPLE

Discover inspiration

Find nearby outdoor spots where others have made art

Why Simple

This is simple because it is a focused, introductory goal that requires little prior experience or accumulated work

MODERATE

Create and share

Follow a prompt or paint freely, then share what you made

Why Moderate

This is moderate because it extends discovery into a personal contribution, requiring the user to decide what they want to express and share

COMPLEX

Find connections to main craft

Find connections across your past “low stress” inspiration to shape a new project in your main craft

Why Complex

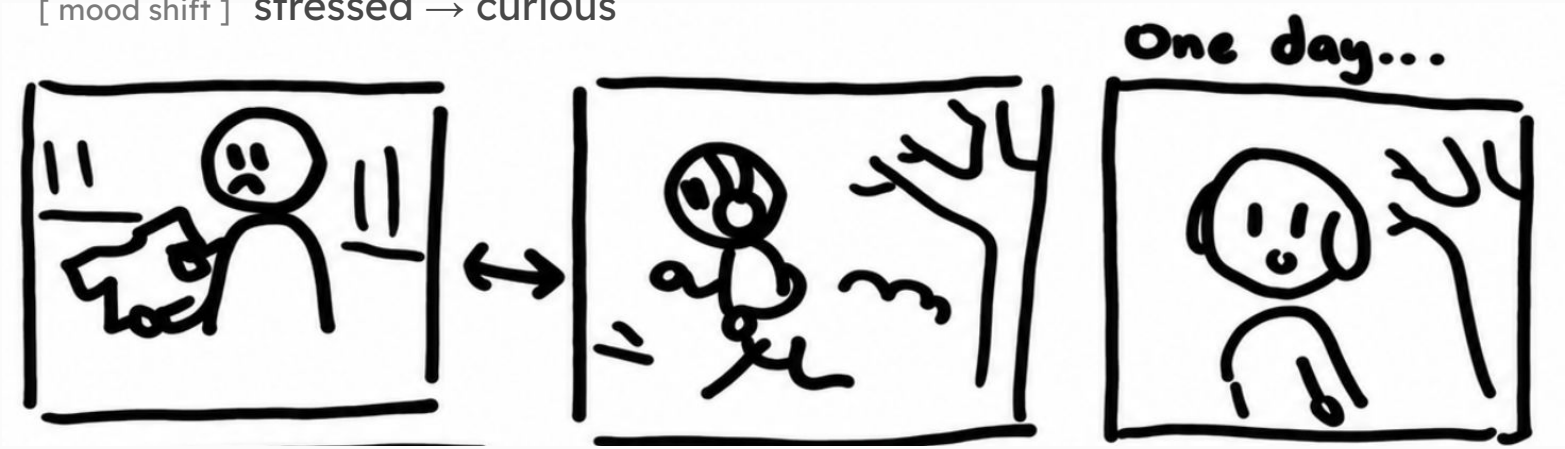
This is complex because it involves drawing meaning from multiple previous experiences and bringing those connections into an ongoing creative practice, making it most relevant to returning, experienced users

Storyboard

[task 1 · simple]

Discover an inspiring spot

[mood shift] stressed → curious



Pressure to produce

Tunnel vision routine

A spark of discovery

[task 1 · simple]

Discover an inspiring spot

Camera: Close-ups of frustration, wide shots of the workspace, and outdoor walking shots.

Transitions: Cuts from the indoor workspace to the outdoor environment.

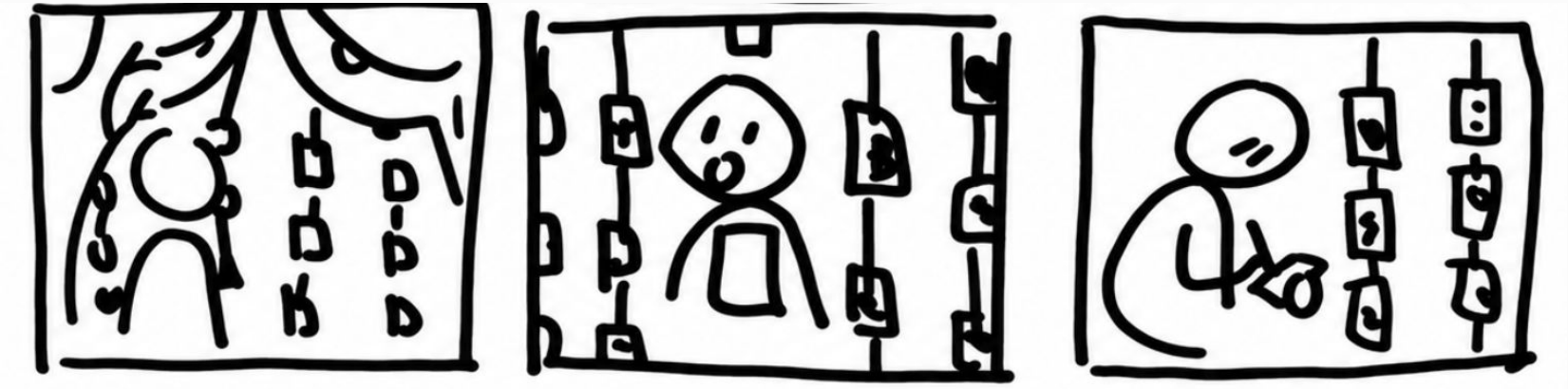
Actions: The character struggles with creative work, leaves the workspace, and encounters an inspiring outdoor setting.

Visual effect: Muted indoor scenes contrast with brighter outdoor scenes.

[task 2 · moderate]

Create freely and share

[mood shift] curious → inspired



Art invites her in

Permission to play

Making for herself

[task 2 · moderate]

Create freely and share

Camera: Close-ups of the sketchbook and hands, followed by medium shots in the fashion workspace.

Transitions: Cuts from outdoor sketching to indoor fashion design.

Actions: The character draws inspiration from her surroundings and incorporates ideas into a dress.

Visual effect: The outdoor discovery becomes a tangible fashion creation.

[task 3 · complex]

Find connections between the “low stress” inspiration and main craft

[mood shift] inspired → empowered



Share her work

Revisit her “low stress” creative explorations

Connect the “low stress”” inspiration to her fashion

[task 3 · complex]

Find connections between the “low stress” inspiration and main craft

Camera: Close-ups of the character drawing, sewing, and handling photographs; wide shot of the outdoor art display.

Transitions: Cuts between creative activities, ending with a reveal of photographs displayed outdoors.

Actions: The character sketches, develops her fashion design, and shares the finished creative journey through displayed images.

Visual effect: The final outdoor display reconnects her creative work with the original location.

OUR CONCEPT VIDEO



OUR CONCEPT VIDEO

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fZAmPD2v1Gg

Task 1: Discover Inspiration (occurs at 0:40 timestamp)

Task 2: Create and Share (occurs at 1:28 timestamp)

Task 3: Find Connections to Main Craft (occurs at 1:10 timestamp)

Sound & Music Design

Opening (Loss of Inspiration):

Steve Lacy's Oh Yeah? starts slowly, creating feelings of sadness and nostalgia.

The music reflects how the character misses the excitement and joy she once felt when creating.

The slower pace highlights her frustration and lack of inspiration.

Sound & Music Design

Turning Point (Finding Inspiration):

As the character discovers the outdoor artwork and removes her headphones, the music fades out.

Birds chirping and nature sounds replace the music, helping the audience focus on her surroundings.

This shift shows her beginning to notice the beauty around her and feel inspired again.

Sound & Music Design

Resolution (Joy of Creating):

The music gradually returns, becoming louder and more upbeat as she starts creating again.

The happier, more energetic part of the song matches her growing excitement and confidence.

The change in music reflects how creating has become fun again rather than something stressful.

Acting & Character Emotions

Opening (Frustration):

The character throws papers, flips through books, and struggles to find ideas.

Her tired expressions, wandering eyes, and slow movements show boredom and frustration.

These actions emphasize how creativity has started to feel like a chore.

Acting & Character Emotions

Turning Point (Curiosity):

She notices the outdoor artwork and stops to look.

Her expression changes from tired to surprised as she explores the display.

Seeing someone else create art sparks her own excitement.

Acting & Character Emotions

Ending (Renewed Joy):

She returns to the design workspace with more energy and excitement.

Instead of struggling, she begins working on her dress with confidence.

The contrast shows how she has rediscovered the joy of creating.

Camera Angles & Framing

Close-Up Shots
- Capture her facial expressions to emphasize frustration, surprise, and happiness.
- Highlight small actions like flipping pages, pulling out sketching tools, and drawing.

Wide Shots
- Establish the dull indoor workspace and the bright outdoor environment.
- Zoom out to reveal the full artwork display and show its impact on her.

Over-the-Shoulder Shots
- Show the artwork from her perspective as she approaches the display.
- Help the audience experience the discovery alongside her.

Camera Movement
- Follow her as she walks toward the artwork to build curiosity.
- Move between wide shots and close-ups to show both the environment and what catches her attention.

Wardrobe & Color Grading

Opening (Dull Colors)

- Gray and black clothing reflect her tired and uninspired mood.
- Muted colors make the workspace feel repetitive and unexciting.

Transition (Changing Mood)

- As she discovers the artwork, the outdoor environment introduces brighter colors.
- The visual change reflects her growing curiosity and excitement.

Ending (Vibrant Colors)

- She wears a bright red shirt when she returns to the design workspace.
- The brighter outfit reflects her renewed energy and happiness.
- More vibrant color grading reinforces the contrast between the beginning and ending.

Scene Transitions & Storytelling

Beginning and Ending Full Circle

The video begins and ends in the same design workspace.

Initially, she struggles to create; by the end, she is excited to work on her dress.

Returning to the same setting highlights how her mindset has changed.

Scene Transitions & Storytelling

Artwork Display Connecting the Story

The outdoor photographs introduce her to other people's creative experiences.

She finds inspiration in their work and begins creating something of her own.

The ending connects her creation back to the outdoor display, completing the creative journey.

Scene Transitions & Storytelling

Sketching Showing the Solution

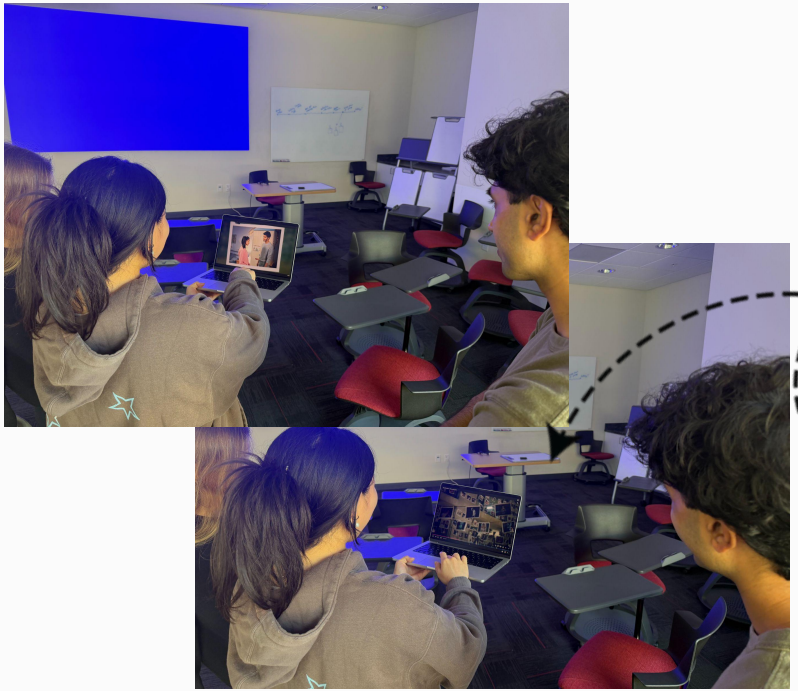
Close-ups show her pulling out the notebook-style phone accessory and beginning to draw.

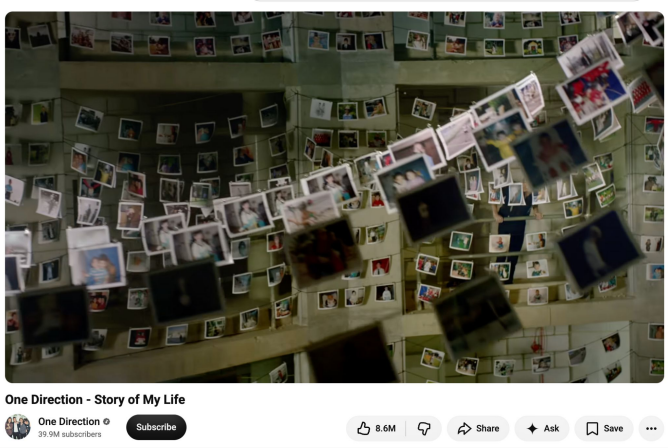
Tearing out a page and continuing her work demonstrates how easily creativity can fit into everyday life.

These moments show the value of the product through her actions rather than relying on a detailed interface.

APPENDIX

CONCEPT VIDEO BRAINSTORMING

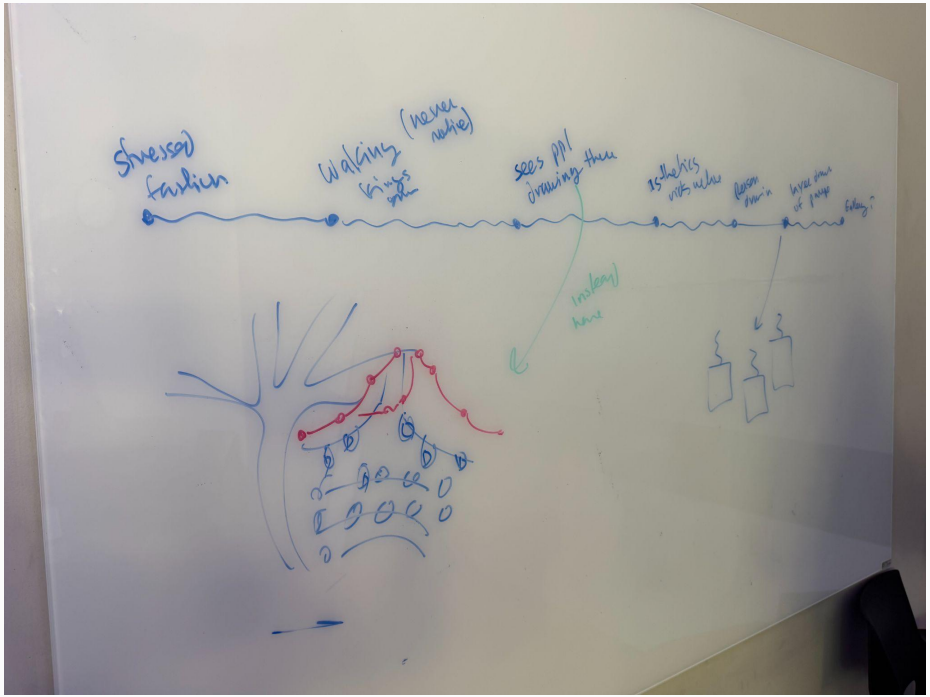




key piece of inspiration
for our concept video

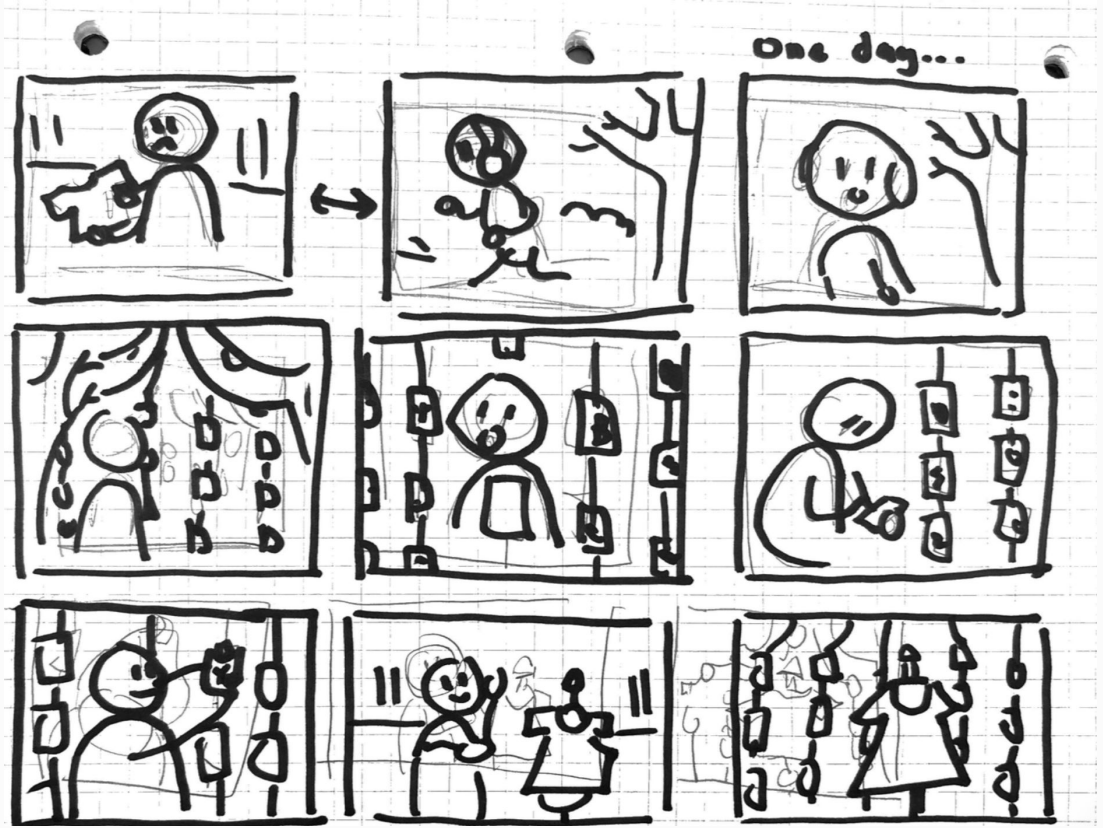
CONCEPT VIDEO BRAINSTORMING



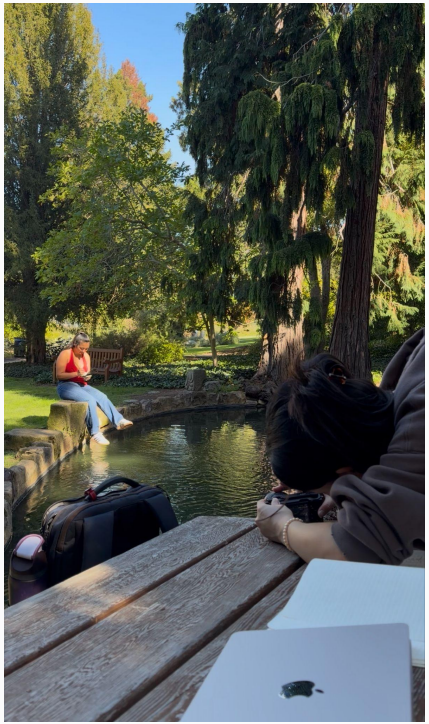


CONCEPT VIDEO STORYBOARD

[condensed]



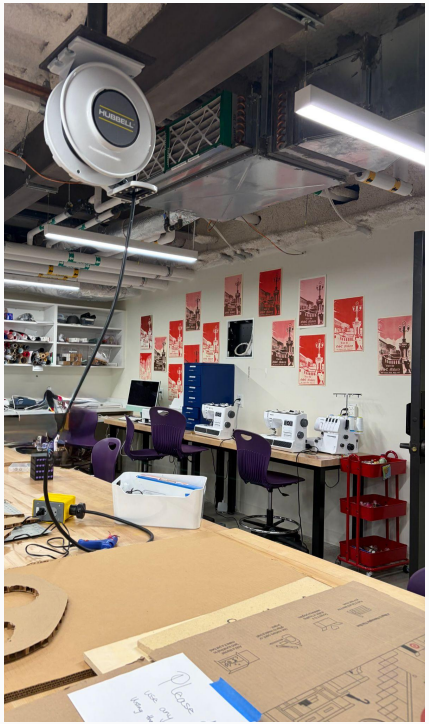
CONCEPT VIDEO SHOOTING







CONCEPT VIDEO SHOOTING





wardrobe

dull -> bright clothing color intentional to match the concept video mood switch

